



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Libya. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — it's great that you're thinking seriously about your future. Since you're 16 and just finished **primary/lower secondary school** in Denmark (called *Folkeskole*), your next step typically involves choosing a path in the **youth education system** (*ungdomsuddannelser*), which prepares you either for a career, further academic education, or both.

Here are the **main options** available to you, along with some advice to help you decide:

## ♦ 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These programs prepare you for **higher education** like university. Ideal if you enjoy academic subjects and want to keep your options open.

### Main types:

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broad academic focus: science, humanities, social sciences.
- **HHX (Handelsskolen)** – Focus on business, economics, international trade.
- **HTX (Teknisk Gymnasium)** – Focus on technology, science, innovation.
- **HF (Højere Forberedelseseksamen)** – Shorter (2 years), good if you want to go to university but prefer less theory-heavy education.

### Best for you if:

You enjoy studying subjects like math, languages, science, history, etc., and are considering university in the future (medicine, engineering, business, law, etc.).

## ♦ 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD/EGU/EUX)

These programs prepare you for specific jobs (electrician, chef, mechanic, healthcare worker, etc.) through a **mix of school and apprenticeship**.

### Variants:

- **EUD** – Standard vocational track.
- **EUX** – A hybrid: vocational + academic (lets you work and still qualify for university).
- **EGU** – For more practical learners, very flexible, often used with support or special programs.

### Best for you if:

You like working with your hands or want to start earning faster. EUX is great if you want both a skilled trade and the option to continue studying.

### ♦ 3. Other Options (10th grade, Efterskole, or Pause)

You can choose:

- **10th grade** (*10. klasse*) – Good if you're unsure or want better grades/preparation.
- **Efterskole** – A year at a boarding school, can be life-changing (focus on personal development, creativity, sports, etc.).
- **Pause/Job** – Not common, but allowed if well planned. You could work, volunteer, or do internships (*praktik*), but keep learning something!

### How to Decide?

Ask yourself:

- Do I like studying theoretical subjects? → Go for STX, HHX, or HTX.
- Do I want to work soon and be hands-on? → Explore EUD or EUX.
- Do I need more time to grow or decide? → Consider 10th grade or Efterskole.

Also, **talk to your school guidance counselor** (*UU-vejleder*) — they are trained to help with exactly this kind of decision and can suggest programs in your local area.

### Personal Thoughts for You

Given you're fluent in Danish and bicultural (Libyan-Danish), you might consider paths that **combine language, communication, and intercultural skills**. For example:

- **HHX + university** → Business, international trade, law.
- **STX + university** → Education, psychology, diplomacy, media, or health fields.
- **EUX** → Great if you want to build practical experience and still go to university later.

And remember: **no path is final**. Denmark has a flexible system — you can always change direction later.

Would you like a simple quiz to help narrow it down or a list of programs near where you live?